MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION MARCH 2026
FOURTH SEMESTER – MG4SECHBMA00 – PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION IN BUSINESS

Part A: Short Answers

Question #	Question	Answer Key
1	Give two indicators of poor listening habits.	Interrupting the speaker before they finish; lack of attention or distraction while someone is speaking.
2	What is the purpose of developing written communication skills?	To communicate ideas, information, and messages clearly, accurately, and professionally in written form in business and academic contexts.
3	State the difference between jargon and slang.	**Jargon** refers to technical or specialized terms used within a particular profession or field, while **slang** refers to informal and casual expressions used in everyday conversation.
4	What does “E-mail” stand for?	Electronic Mail.
5	Define a Letter of Enquiry.	A letter of enquiry is a formal business letter written to request information about products, services, prices, or terms from an organization.
6	Why is summarization important in reports?	Summarization highlights the key points of a report in a concise form, helping readers quickly understand the main findings and conclusions.
7	List the two primary layouts used for business letters.	Full block format and modified block format.
8	Write two benefits of maintaining eye contact while speaking.	It builds trust and confidence; it keeps the audience engaged and attentive.
9	Define articulation in vocal delivery.	Articulation refers to the clear and precise pronunciation of words while speaking.
10	List two simple ways to organize a presentation.	Chronological order; problem–solution method.
11	What are the two types of slides often used: PowerPoint and Google Slides?	PowerPoint slides and Google Slides presentations.
12	Define Stage Presence.	Stage presence is the confidence, body language, voice control, and overall ability of a speaker to engage and command the attention of the audience while presenting.
13	How does active listening help when accepting feedback?	Active listening helps a person fully understand the feedback, avoid misunderstandings, and respond thoughtfully, which improves learning and communication.

14	Why is empathy important for conflict resolution?	Empathy helps individuals understand others' feelings and perspectives, making it easier to resolve disagreements and reach mutual understanding.
15	What is the risk of interrupting a questioner?	Interrupting a questioner may cause misunderstanding, appear disrespectful, and prevent the speaker from fully expressing their point.

Part B: Short Essays

16	What's the difference between pretending to listen and only picking what you want to hear? Why are both bad when working in teams?	Pretending to listen means acting as if one is listening while actually ignoring the message, whereas selective listening means hearing only the parts that match one's interests or opinions. Both are harmful in teams because they cause misunderstandings, reduce trust, and prevent effective collaboration and decision-making.
17	Why should you notice your own body language and face when someone disagrees with you?	Being aware of body language and facial expressions helps maintain professionalism, avoid appearing defensive or aggressive, and promote respectful communication during disagreements.
18	What should be included and how should you write a letter if you want to complain about something, and what is a "call to action"?	A complaint letter should include the sender's address, date, recipient's address, subject, salutation, clear explanation of the problem, supporting details, and a polite request for a solution. The tone should be formal and respectful. A **call to action** is a clear request asking the recipient to take specific steps to resolve the issue.
19	How does planning for your audience before writing connect to checking and correcting your writing after?	Planning for the audience helps choose appropriate language, tone, and content. During revision and proofreading, the writer checks whether the message is clear, suitable for the audience, and free from errors.
20	What's the difference between a resume and an application form? How does each help someone get a job?	A **resume** is a personalized document highlighting a candidate's education, skills, and experience, while an **application form** is a standardized form provided by employers to collect applicant information. Both help employers evaluate qualifications and select suitable candidates.
21	How does telling stories help make hard topics easier to understand in a presentation?	Stories make complex ideas relatable and memorable by providing real-life examples, engaging the audience emotionally, and simplifying abstract concepts.

Part C: Essays

22	Discuss the various external and internal pressures (e.g., globalization, hierarchy, technology) that complicate the decoding process for a message receiver in a large corporation.	In large corporations, several factors affect how messages are interpreted. **Globalization** introduces language differences and cultural variations that may alter meaning. **Hierarchy** can distort messages as information passes through multiple organizational levels. **Technology** such as emails, messaging platforms, and virtual meetings may remove tone and non-verbal cues, causing misunderstanding. Internal pressures like workload, stress, and organizational politics may also influence how a receiver interprets a message. These factors make accurate decoding challenging and require clear communication practices.
23	Explain the effect of posture, gestures, and facial expressions on communication.	Posture, gestures, and facial expressions are important aspects of non-verbal communication. Good posture conveys confidence and professionalism, while appropriate gestures help emphasize ideas and make communication more engaging. Facial expressions express emotions and attitudes, helping listeners understand the speaker's feelings. Positive non-verbal signals strengthen the message, while negative signals such as crossed arms or frowning may create misunderstanding or reduce credibility.
24	Write an essay on strategies to accept criticism positively.	Accepting criticism positively is an important communication and personal development skill. Strategies include listening carefully without interrupting, staying calm and avoiding defensive reactions, and trying to understand the intention behind the feedback. Asking questions for clarification can help improve understanding. It is also important to evaluate criticism objectively and identify useful suggestions for improvement. Showing appreciation for constructive feedback helps build professional relationships. Finally, using criticism as an opportunity for learning and self-improvement can lead to personal and professional growth.